INCH-POUND

A-A-51847B
19 March 1993

SUPERSEDING
A-A-51847A
17 June 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

INDICATOR, STERILIZATION

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description

This Commercial Item Description covers sterilization indicators designed for placement inside packages prepared for steam or ethylene oxide (EtO) sterilization.

Salient characteristics:

Sterilization indicators shall be designed for placement inside packages containing items to be sterilized by use of steam or ethylene oxide/freon rich gas mixtures (12/88). Indicators described here are not for use in 100% ethylene oxide sterilization cycles. Indicators shall be constructed of sensitized paper and display a linear scale, single bar design. The single bar shall have as one end point an area marked unsafe or reject, as applicable. The single bar shall have as a second end point an area marked safe or accept, as applicable. A distinct color change along the bar from the area marked unsafe or reject into the area marked safe or accept shall be proof the item has been exposed to the parameters necessary to achieve sterilization.

AMSC N/A

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Indicators designed for use in steam sterilization procedures shall indicate or show parameters of steam, time, and temperature. Indicators showing safe or accept indicate parameters necessary to achieve steam sterilization have been met or exceeded.

Indicators designed for use in 12% ethylene oxide/88% freon sterilization procedures shall indicate or show parameters of EtO concentration, time, temperature , and relative humidity. Indicators showing safe or accept indicate parameters necessary to achieve EtO sterilization have been met or exceeded.

Indicators shall be removed from the sterilized package and interpreted by the end user who must decide the product sterilized is safe for use. Aeration of EtO sterilized items and prolonged storage of steam and EtO sterilized items shall have no affect on the indicator.

Complete and detailed instructions for the use and interpretation of indicators shall be provided with each unit.

Indicators covered by this document shall be of the following styles:

Style A - For EtO Sterilization. Color change from Reject to Accept, 1000's

Style B - For LtO Sterilization. Color change from Unsafe to Safe, 2000's

Style C - For Steam Sterilization Color change from Reject to Accept, 1000's.

Workmanship. The indicators shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing one thousand indicators for style A and C or one package containing two thousand indicators for style B, as specified, constitutes one unit.

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QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination and tests. Sampling for examination and tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-1. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one package of sterilization indicators.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction , the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered material. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc , involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTES: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN	Item Identification	Style
6530-01-233-4404	INDICATOR, STERILIZATION	A
6530-01-345-4091	INDICATOR, STERILIZATION	B
6530-01-280-2328	INDICATOR, STERILIZATION	C

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No 6530-2397

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER: A-A-51847B	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD): 19 March 1993

3. DOCUMENT TITLE: INDICATOR, STERILIZATION

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (*Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.*)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (*Last, First, Middle Initial*)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (*Include Zip Code*)	d. TELEPHONE (*Include Area Code*) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (*If applicable*)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (*Include Area Code*) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON
c. ADDRESS (*Include Zip Code*)	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340

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